Notes 7

Linux Wildcards

Wildcards are characters used to match multiple filenames.

1. Asterisk (*)

Matches zero or more characters.

Examples:

- ls *.txt - Shows all files ending in .txt.
- ls photo* - Shows files starting with photo. ls *2026* - Shows files containing 2026.

2. Question Mark (?)

Matches exactly one character.

Examples:

- ls file?.txt - Matches file1.txt or fileA.txt.
- ls ???.txt - Matches three-character filenames ending in .txt.

3. Square Brackets ([])

Matches one character from a group or range.

Examples:

- ls file[123].txt - Matches file1.txt, file2.txt, or file3.txt.
- ls [abc]* - Matches files starting with a, b, or c.
- ls file[1-5].txt - Matches file1.txt through file5.txt.

Brace Expansion

Brace expansion creates multiple names or directories with one command.

Example 1

```
mkdir {music,photos,videos}
```

Creates three directories: music, photos, and videos.

Example 2

```
mkdir -p website/{assets/{images,css,js},documents}
```

Creates a website directory with assets, images, css, js, and documents folders.

Example 3

```
mkdir -p school/{classes/{math,science,english},assignments}
```

Creates a school directory with classes, math, science, english, and assignments folders.